Inbound Lead Report: Rodrigo Castillo - Sociedad Quimica y Minera de Chile (SQM)

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> **P1 warm inbound (Anglo American referral): Rodrigo Castillo, Head of Operations, Northern Operations Division at SQM, wants autonomous inspection to replace expensive, hazardous contracted crews at 3 large 24/7 Atacama lithium sites. FlytBase's case study shows SQM already runs FlytBase docks with Chilean integrator Adentu [S1], so treat this as an expansion of an existing account: AE-led, with Adentu as co-sell partner.**

Assignment requirements check

Each requirement in the assignment PDF, checked in Python against the stage output.

Stage	Requirement	Met
1 Qualification	Framework stated and explained	yes
1 Qualification	Known information extracted from the email (Identify Pain)	yes
1 Qualification	Missing information required for full qualification (Metrics, Economic Buyer, Decision Criteria, Decision Process, Paper Process, Champion, Competition)	yes
1 Qualification	Fit assessment (every ICP factor rated with a reason)	yes
1 Qualification	Priority score with reasoning (77/100, P1 - Hot: respond same business day, involve AE early)	yes
2 Deep account research	Organizational structure and reporting lines (INFERENCE (not sourced): The contact's title 'Head of Operations, Northern Operations Division' does not match any unit named in public sources. If his three sites are Atacama lithium operations, he most likely sits inside Novandino's operations line, reporting to or alongside the Salar operations	yes

Stage	Requirement	Met
	manager or lithium operations manager, who report to the Novandino general manager. Budget approval would probably involve the general manager and the Codelco-designated finance manager. Technical evaluation would likely go to the maintenance and automation manager and the digitalization and IT manager, and vendor onboarding to supply chain. If his sites are instead in the Iodine and Plant Nutrition division, the existing FlytBase/Adentu deployment there makes the digital innovation team the closest internal link.)	
2 Deep account research	Budget signals from public filings (capex, opex, technology)	yes
2 Deep account research	Recent news, press releases, strategic announcements	yes
2 Deep account research	Stakeholder or investor letters revealing priorities	yes
2 Deep account research	Synthesized FlytBase positioning recommendation	yes
2 Deep account research	All research real: every kept claim cites a stored source and passed the fact-check (43 claims checked, 0 removed)	yes
3 Response generation	Reflects Stage 2 research (each email cites kept research) (email 1: S1; email 2: S1; email 3: S32, S2, S1; email 4: S15)	yes
3 Response generation	Aims to discover the Stage 1 unknowns (email 1: Metrics, Economic Buyer; email 2: Decision Criteria; email 3: Champion, Decision Process; email 4: Paper Process)	yes
3 Response generation	Tone adapted to seniority, industry and stated context	yes
3 Response generation	Clear progression logic (why this email, then this email) (4 emails, 8 reply branches)	yes
3 Response generation	Playbook: Email 1 fits one phone screen (<= 200 words) (192 words)	yes
3 Response generation	Playbook: Email 1 asks at most 2 questions plus the CTA (<= 3 '?') (3 question marks)	yes
3 Response generation	Playbook: Email 1 CTA offers two specific time options (10:00, 15:00)	yes

Stage	Requirement	Met
3 Response generation	Playbook: Email 1 is about the buyer (you/your >= we/our, <= 2 sentences start with I/We) (you 7 vs we 0; 0 I/We sentence starts)	yes
3 Response generation	Playbook: every follow-up is shorter than Email 1 and <= 120 words (email 2: 95 words; email 3: 109 words; email 4: 72 words)	yes
3 Response generation	Playbook: one ask, at most 1 link per email (email 1: 0; email 2: 0; email 3: 0; email 4: 0)	yes
3 Response generation	Playbook: no banned phrases, buzzwords, AI tells or placeholders (clean)	yes
3 Response generation	Playbook: subjects describe the content (<= 8 words, no '!', emoji or fake Fwd:) (ok)	yes
3 Response generation	Playbook: every email signed by the named BDR (ok)	yes
3 Response generation	Playbook: final email closes the loop respectfully (close the loop, check back, hold this, better placed)	yes
4 Case study matching	Autonomously searched FlytBase's public website for case studies (24 case studies scanned)	yes
4 Case study matching	Referral connection identified (no hard-coding) (found=True https://flytbase.com/case-studies/anglo-american-autonomous-mining-drones-peru-case-study)	yes
4 Case study matching	Matched on industry, use case and operational context	yes
4 Case study matching	Explains why the case study is the strongest fit (How SQM Turned a 678 km^2 Mine into an Autonomous Inspection Zone)	yes
4 Case study matching	Primary match is a page the crawler actually read	yes
5 Partner identification	Direct AE or partner-led motion for the region decided (AE-led with partner (co-sell))	yes
5 Partner identification	Justified by region, deal complexity and partner availability	yes
5 Partner identification	If partner-led: specific partner type and rationale (Adentu (System Integrator), Dronestore Chile (System Integrator), UAVLatam (System Integrator))	yes
5 Partner identification	Every named partner appears in a stored source	yes
6 AE handoff	Buyer context: who he is, what he cares about, who else is involved	yes

Stage	Requirement	Met
6 AE handoff	Qualification status: framework score, knowns, unknowns	yes
6 AE handoff	Top 3 research highlights, each citing kept research	yes
6 AE handoff	Recommended case study and why	yes
6 AE handoff	Suggested next step with rationale (BDR sends Email 1 today (reply on his thread, SQM case study as proof, two questions on sites/inspection frequency and who joins the Q3 budget conversation, Spanish offered). In parallel, check with the FlytBase SQM account owner and confirm Adentu's current partner status before Adentu is named in any call invite. AE joins the 30-minute discovery call on one of the proposed slots, Tue 10 Nov 10:00 or Wed 11 Nov 15:00 Santiago time. On the call: confirm his role and entity (SQM vs Novandino), which 3 sites, which Q3 and who owns the budget, what a solution must prove in Atacama conditions, and the vendor onboarding path. Close by proposing a one-site docked pilot with Adentu, scoped for his budget conversation.)	yes

Stage 1 - Qualification (MEDDPICC)

Why MEDDPICC: MEDDPICC fits this lead because SQM is describing an enterprise industrial purchase: three large-scale, 24/7 lithium sites in the Atacama, where operations (Rodrigo, Head of Operations for the Northern Operations Division), safety, IT/OT and procurement will all weigh in. The Anglo American referral and LATAM region suggest a partner or integrator may shape the deal, which MEDDPICC tracks through Champion and Competition. The email also leaves clear gaps: who owns the budget (Economic Buyer), how the Q3 budget conversation turns into a decision (Decision Process), and the contracting path (Paper Process). MEDDPICC makes those gaps explicit so the first emails can target them. BANT would only capture budget/authority/need/timeline and would miss the buying committee and procurement path; SPICED is designed for recurring SaaS expansion motions rather than a new multi-site industrial deployment.

ICP fit	MEDDPICC completeness	Priority score	Tier
91/100	44%	**77/100**	P1 - Hot: respond same business day, involve AE early

Formula: priority = 0.7 x ICP fit + 0.3 x MEDDPICC completeness; tier set by ICP fit (>=75 P1, >=55 P2)

Element	Status	Known from email	Missing	Discovery question
Metrics	partial	Contracted crews are expensive and hazardous; 3 sites running 24/7	Quantified targets: current crew inspection spend, inspection frequency, hours, safety incidents, desired coverage	Roughly what do you spend on contracted inspection crews across the three sites today, and how often do they inspect?
Economic Buyer	partial	Internal budget conversation scheduled for Q3 (budget owner not named)	Who owns and signs the budget; whether Rodrigo holds it or it sits with division/corporate leadership	Who will be leading the Q3 budget conversation, and who would ultimately sign off on a program like this?
Decision Criteria	unknown	-	Technical and commercial criteria: desert conditions (heat, dust, wind), docking/BVLOS, integration, data security, pricing model	What would a solution need to prove for you to consider it a success at Atacama (for example dust and heat tolerance, remote operations, integrations)?
Decision Process	partial	Internal budget conversation scheduled for Q3	Steps, stakeholders and timeline after Q3; whether a pilot is expected	After the Q3 budget discussion, what are the next steps to a decision, and would you want a pilot at one site first?
Paper Process	unknown	-	Procurement, legal, IT/security review and vendor onboarding path at SQM	How does SQM typically bring on a new technology vendor: procurement tender, security review, or a pilot agreement first?
Identify Pain	known	Contracted crews are expensive and hazardous	Business consequence in numbers (cost overruns, incidents, downtime) and what triggered the search now	What prompted you to look at autonomous inspection now, and what happens if the crew model stays as it is?
Champion	partial	Rodrigo Castillo, Head of Operations, reached out directly via flytbase.com/contact	Whether Rodrigo will actively sell internally and has influence over the budget owner	Who else on your team would be involved in evaluating this, and how can we help you make the case internally?

Element	Status	Known from email	Missing	Discovery question
Competition	partial	Status quo is contracted inspection crews; referred by Anglo American	Other drone vendors or in-house options being evaluated; what Anglo American uses	Are you looking at other drone or inspection providers, or considering building an in-house drone team?

Fit assessment

Factor	Weight	Rating (0-5)	Reason
industry_fit	20	5	Lithium extraction / mining in the Atacama Desert: heavy industry with large outdoor assets
site_scale	15	5	"3 large-scale" lithium extraction sites
continuous_operations	10	5	Sites described as "24/7"
pain_severity	15	5	"Contracted crews are expensive and hazardous": cost and safety pain that autonomy directly removes
buyer_authority	15	4	"Head of Operations, Northern Operations Division": senior operational owner, but budget authority not confirmed
warm_introduction	10	5	"Referred by Anglo American"
timing_and_budget	15	3	"Internal budget conversation scheduled for Q3": a process exists but budget is not approved and amount is unknown

Verdict: SQM is a strong ICP fit: a senior operations leader at a major lithium miner asking for autonomous inspection across 3 large 24/7 Atacama sites, with clear cost and safety pain and a warm referral from Anglo American. The main gaps are the Economic Buyer, Decision Criteria and Paper Process, and the budget is only at the Q3 conversation stage, so discovery should focus on budget ownership and the path to a decision.

Risks: Budget not yet approved; depends on the Q3 internal conversation; Economic Buyer unknown; Rodrigo may need division or corporate sign-off; Paper process unknown; large mining companies often require lengthy procurement, security and safety reviews; Harsh Atacama conditions (dust, heat, wind, remote sites) may raise technical decision criteria; Competing drone vendors or incumbent inspection contractors not yet identified

Stage 2 - Deep Account Research

Organisational structure

- In December 2025 the Novandino board appointed Carlos Díaz, previously general manager of SQM Litio, as Novandino general manager and Eduardo Foix, designated by Codelco, as finance manager. [S17, S15] *(partially verified)*
- *So what:* Díaz is the top operational executive for the Atacama lithium sites; a Codelco-appointed finance manager likely sits in the budget approval path.
- Novandino's board has three Codelco directors (Máximo Pacheco, chair; Josefina Montenegro; Alfredo Moreno) and three SQM directors (Ricardo Ramos, vice chair; Hernán Uribe; Manuel Ovalle). [S7, S13, S17]
- *So what:* Large capital decisions at the lithium operations involve a joint public-private board, so FlytBase should frame the deal as operating budget or a low-capex pilot that sits below board level.
- According to DF, Díaz's direct team includes Gilbert Maldonado (Salar operations manager), Humberto Carvajal (lithium operations manager), Rodrigo Maffioletti (VP lithium projects), Gerson Salas (maintenance and automation manager) and Germán Pérez (supply chain manager). [S15]
- *So what:* These are the operational, automation and procurement roles that an autonomous inspection program at the Salar would touch.
- DF reports that José Miguel Berguño's corporate services and sustainability vice presidency includes the digitalization and IT manager (Andrés Pinto), the environment manager (Julio García) and a risk management superintendency led by Luis Acuña. [S15]
- *So what:* IT/OT security review and risk/safety sign-off for drones would likely route through this vice presidency.
- An undated DF report on SQM's internal restructuring said the Lithium and Potassium division grouped the Salar de Atacama operations and had two main sites: the Carmen chemical plant in Antofagasta and the Salar de Atacama facilities. [S8]
- *So what:* Public sources describe two main lithium sites rather than three, so the BDR should confirm which three sites the lead means.

Stakeholders found in public sources

- **Carlos Díaz**, General Manager, Nova Andino Litio - Top executive over the Atacama lithium operations; likely final operational sponsor for a multi-site program. [S15, S17]
- **Gilbert Maldonado**, Gerente de operaciones salar (Salar operations manager) - Owns Salar de Atacama operations where inspection crews work; a likely peer or superior of the contact. [S15]
- **Humberto Carvajal**, Gerente de operaciones litio (lithium operations manager) - Owns lithium plant operations; relevant if any of the three sites include the Carmen plant. [S15]
- **Gerson Salas**, Gerente de mantenimiento y automatización (maintenance and automation manager); previously quoted as SQM automation and energy manager - Owns automation and

maintenance, the natural technical evaluator for docked drones. [S15, S21]
- **Andrés Pinto**, Gerente de digitalización y TI (digitalization and IT manager) - Will review data integration, cloud and cybersecurity for the drone platform. [S15]
- **Germán Pérez**, Gerente supply chain - Likely owns the vendor onboarding and procurement path (Paper Process). [S15]
- **Eduardo Foix**, Finance manager, Nova Andino Litio (Codelco-designated) - Likely in the budget approval path for the Q3 budget conversation. [S17]
- **Rodrigo Toler**, Deputy Manager of Digital Innovation, SQM - Internal champion of SQM's existing FlytBase and Adentu docked-drone program; a credible internal reference. [S1]

Likely reporting line (inference): INFERENCE (not sourced): The contact's title 'Head of Operations, Northern Operations Division' does not match any unit named in public sources. If his three sites are Atacama lithium operations, he most likely sits inside Novandino's operations line, reporting to or alongside the Salar operations manager or lithium operations manager, who report to the Novandino general manager. Budget approval would probably involve the general manager and the Codelco-designated finance manager. Technical evaluation would likely go to the maintenance and automation manager and the digitalization and IT manager, and vendor onboarding to supply chain. If his sites are instead in the Iodine and Plant Nutrition division, the existing FlytBase/Adentu deployment there makes the digital innovation team the closest internal link.

Budget signals (capex / opex / technology)

- In its 2Q2026 earnings release (18 August 2026), SQM guided capex of about US$3 billion for 2026-2028, roughly 60% for Novandino, including about US$300 million per year of sustaining capex across divisions. [S11]
- *So what:* About US$1.8 billion is earmarked for the lithium operations, and sustaining capex is a natural home for inspection and maintenance technology.
- In November 2025 SQM cut its 2025-2027 capex estimate to US$2.7 billion from US$3.1-3.8 billion, postponed some investment decisions and said about one quarter would go to maintenance. [S9]
- *So what:* Management was capital-disciplined in late 2025, so a low-capex, fast-payback pitch fits better than a large infrastructure ask.
- SQM's 2025 annual report chair letter says the company invested more than US$876 million in strategic projects in 2025. [S33]
- *So what:* Spending continues at scale, and a drone program is small relative to it.
- In 1H2026 SQM reported net income of US$1,024.7 million on revenues of US$4,228.5 million, and Novandino's average realized lithium price in 2Q2026 was about US$21.8/kg, up close to 160% year on year. [S11]
- *So what:* Strong 2026 cash generation improves the odds that a Q3 budget request for inspection automation gets funded.

- Novandino's Salar Futuro project contemplates about US$3 billion of investment over roughly seven years after approvals; Reporte Minero reports construction planned from 2H2029 to 2H2036. [S11, S12]
- *So what:* A long build programme in the salar creates future inspection and progress-monitoring demand beyond current operations.

Recent news and announcements

- On 27 December 2025 Codelco and SQM announced Nova Andino Litio SpA, formed by merging Minera Tarar SpA and SQM Salar SpA, to develop lithium in the Salar de Atacama until 2060. [S7]
- *So what:* The lead's company is mid-transition to a new operating entity, which can either speed up new tooling choices or slow procurement.
- In July 2026 Novandino submitted the environmental impact study for 'Continuidad Operacional y Desarrollo Minero Futuro en el Salar de Atacama' (Salar Futuro), with an estimated US$3,000 million investment to extend operations to 2060. [S12, S11]
- *So what:* Environmental monitoring commitments in the study create additional use cases for repeatable aerial data capture.
- On 17 February 2026 Chile's Dirección del Trabajo partially suspended work at SQM Salar for lacking drinking water and toilets within legal distance for outdoor workers, and suspended a contractor for insufficient protective equipment against thermal swings at about 2,300 m altitude. [S30, S31]
- *So what:* Field-worker exposure in the salar is under regulatory scrutiny, which strengthens the safety case for reducing on-foot inspection rounds.
- SQM's 4Q2025 release said Novandino reported record quarterly sales of over 66,000 tonnes and was operating at full capacity. [S19]
- *So what:* Running at full capacity raises the cost of undetected issues and supports continuous, automated inspection.
- In August 2026 SQM guided Novandino 2026 production of 280,000-290,000 tonnes LCE and production capacity above 300,000 tonnes by end-2027. [S11]
- *So what:* Volume growth on the same footprint increases inspection workload without proportional headcount, which suits autonomy.

Investor / stakeholder priorities

- In the 2025 annual report, board chair Gina Ocqueteau names the Codelco partnership securing operations to 2060 as a key milestone and says the challenge is executing with operational excellence, innovation and financial discipline. [S33]
- *So what:* FlytBase should frame the deal around operational excellence and innovation at a disciplined cost.

- SQM's 2025 annual report lists Excellence, Safety, Integrity and Sustainability as the company's core values. [S33]
- *So what:* Safety is a stated corporate value, so removing crews from hazardous terrain lines up with what leadership already says publicly.
- CEO Ricardo Ramos said in August 2026 that Salar Futuro aims to keep increasing lithium production while significantly reducing the environmental footprint, including eliminating continental water use in the production process. [S11] *(partially verified)*
- *So what:* Drone-based thermal and visual monitoring can support the environmental and water monitoring this commitment needs.
- In April 2026 Codelco chair Máximo Pacheco said Novandino had 2,500 workers and projected US$2,100 million in contributions to the Chilean State in 2026. [S13]
- *So what:* The state partner is focused on output and fiscal returns, so cost and uptime are the arguments that work for both shareholders.
- In a July 2024 interview, SQM's automation and energy manager Gerson Salas described priorities of reducing freshwater use, electrifying the fleet, energy efficiency and investing in start-ups through SQM Lithium Ventures. [S21]
- *So what:* The automation lead is already open to new technology and efficiency projects; electric, docked drones fit that agenda.

Operations context

- The Dirección del Trabajo describes the SQM Salar site as located at about 2,300 metres in San Pedro de Atacama, with outdoor workers exposed to significant thermal swings. [S30, S31]
- *So what:* Harsh outdoor conditions are both the pain point (crew exposure) and a technical criterion (heat, dust, wind) FlytBase must address.
- The Salar Futuro study covers a territorial reorganization of 52,587 hectares (64% of the area leased from Corfo) and includes monitoring of hydrogeology, biota, air quality and social aspects. [S14]
- *So what:* The area is very large, and periodic monitoring of it is a scale problem that docked drones address.
- The project is organized into five sectors (Núcleo, Oeste/Salar Futuro, Este, roads and inter-plant pipeline, and electrical infrastructure), with the Este sector hosting hydrogeological monitoring and two new transmission lines planned. [S12]
- *So what:* Pipelines, roads, ponds and power lines are classic linear and area assets for autonomous inspection routes.
- DF reported that 3,533 SQM Litio workers moved into Nova Andino at launch and that the Carmen lithium chemical plant had 210,000 tonnes LCE capacity with a goal of 240,000 in 2026. [S17]
- *So what:* The Carmen plant is a possible second deployment site beyond the salar. Note that Pacheco's later figure of 2,500 workers (S13) differs from DF's 3,533.

- An undated DF article on SQM's restructuring reported that SQM had about 2,000 contractors in addition to its own staff. [S8]
- *So what:* Heavy use of contractors supports the lead's statement that contracted crews are a major cost line, though the figure is dated.

Technology and drone adoption

- FlytBase's case study says SQM, with Chilean integrator Adentu, runs DJI Dock-based autonomous drones on FlytBase across a 678 km² operation in northern Chile, sending RGB and thermal data to SQM's Azure environment, with connectivity over Starlink. [S1]
- *So what:* SQM is already a FlytBase customer, so this lead is an expansion into lithium rather than a cold start, with proven integration and desert reliability.
- The same case study reports more than 95% mission reliability, detection time under 90 minutes, a total system investment of USD 70,000-80,000 with ROI in under a year, and additional docks ordered for SQM's security department for 24/7 surveillance. [S1, S10]
- *So what:* This gives the lead an internal, numbers-backed business case to bring to the Q3 budget conversation.
- An ANDRITZ success story describes SQM's Automation and Energy Management Department and a phased digital transformation including asset management with Metris and a digital twin at the PQLC lithium plant. [S20]
- *So what:* SQM has an established automation function and works with industrial technology vendors, which lowers the risk of adopting autonomy.
- FlytBase reported in May 2025 that Anglo American Peru deployed a FlytBase-powered drone-in-a-box system at its Quellaveco mine with regional partner UAV Latam, running scheduled inspections without on-site pilots. [S32, S2]
- *So what:* This explains the Anglo American referral and gives a peer mining reference for remote, pilot-free operations in the Andes.
- The Salar Futuro project plans technologies such as forced evaporation, membrane separation and direct lithium extraction (DLE). [S12]
- *So what:* Novandino is investing in new process technology, so operations teams are already used to adopting new tools.

Positioning recommendation: Position FlytBase as an expansion of an autonomy program SQM already runs, not a new vendor trial. The FlytBase and Adentu deployment at SQM's 678 km² operation has published reliability, payback and safety results [S1]; offer to replicate it at the Atacama lithium operations now run by Novandino [S7]. Lead with removing contracted crews from hazardous outdoor rounds at about 2,300 m, where regulators have recently scrutinized conditions [S30], and with low capex that fits SQM's sustaining budget and capital discipline [S11][S9]. Propose a one-site docked pilot through the existing local integrator, timed to the budget cycle, with a path to the other sites.

- Internal proof point: SQM's own FlytBase/Adentu program reached over 95% mission reliability and paid back in under a year on a USD 70-80k investment [S1].
- Safety and compliance: the February 2026 Dirección del Trabajo suspension at SQM Salar, including a contractor, shows exposure risk for outdoor field crews; autonomous inspections reduce people on the salar [S30][S31].
- Budget fit: the 2026-2028 capex guidance includes about US$300M/year of sustaining capex and about 60% for Novandino, so a modest inspection program fits existing lines [S11].
- Scale: Salar Futuro covers 52,587 ha with pipelines, ponds, roads, transmission lines and hydrogeological monitoring; drone-in-a-box routes can serve both operations and environmental monitoring [S14][S12].
- Peer validation: Anglo American's Quellaveco drone-in-a-box deployment with UAV Latam runs scheduled inspections without on-site pilots [S32].
- Operational excellence plus innovation, which the 2025 chair letter names as the company's challenge [S33].

Likely objections: The contact's name and his 'Northern Operations Division' do not appear in any public source; confirm his role, entity (SQM vs Novandino) and which three sites he means before proposing scope.; Public sources describe two main lithium sites (Salar de Atacama and the Carmen plant), not three; the third site may be in another division.; Novandino is a new joint venture with a Codelco-appointed finance manager and a joint board, which may add approval layers and state-company procurement rules.; SQM cut capex guidance in November 2025 and postponed some investments, so expect pressure on payback and pricing.; Today is November 2026, so the Q3 budget conversation mentioned in the email has likely already happened; ask what was decided.; Some teams may have already engaged Adentu or other drone vendors directly; position with the existing integrator to avoid channel conflict.; BVLOS and remote operations over large salar areas may require regulatory approvals in Chile.

Searched for but not found: Any public record of the contact (Rodrigo Castillo) or of a 'Northern Operations Division' at SQM or Novandino.; Current SQM or Novandino spend on contracted inspection crews, inspection frequency or contractor counts specific to the lithium sites.; 2025 contractor safety statistics (LTIFR, incidents) for the lithium operations; the 2025 annual report has a safety section but its figures were not retrieved.; Whether drones are already used at the Salar de Atacama lithium operations, as distinct from the iodine/nitrate leaching operation in the FlytBase case study.; Novandino's procurement or vendor onboarding process and any open tenders for inspection services.; Q3 2026 results or post-August 2026 capex updates.; LinkedIn profiles for operations and procurement leaders (LinkedIn pages could not be read; Chrome tools not used).; Novandino's presentation on Maintenance 4.0 and prescriptive analytics at MAPLA-Mantemin 2026 (only a search snippet; the LinkedIn page was blocked).

Fact-check: 0 claim(s) were removed because the cited source did not support them.

Stage 3 - Adaptive Email Sequence

Strategy: Email 1 answers Mr. Castillo's request in his own terms (three 24/7 Atacama lithium sites, costly and hazardous contracted crews, Anglo American referral, Q3 budget conversation) and uses SQM's own FlytBase and Adentu deployment as the single proof point, then asks about Metrics and the Economic Buyer and offers two Santiago-time slots. If he goes quiet, each follow-up adds one new useful item aimed at a different gap: Email 2 gives the IT and connectivity precedent and turns the call into a Decision Criteria session, Email 3 gives the referrer's own peer deployment plus a forwardable summary so he can carry the case internally (Champion, Decision Process), and Email 4 closes the loop, offers to hold until the Q3 budget conversation and asks about the vendor onboarding path (Paper Process). The asks get smaller as the sequence goes on, and every email stands on its own in the same thread.

Email 1 - Same business hour as the inbound (Thursday 5 November 2026, Santiago business hours), in reply to his original thread

Goal: Confirm we understood his request, show SQM's own verified precedent and book a 30-minute discovery call
Gaps targeted: Metrics, Economic Buyer
Why this email now: He asked us directly and is a P1 lead (ICP fit 91), so the reply must go out within the hour. Mirroring his own words earns agreement, and SQM's own deployment (S1) is the most relevant proof that exists: same company, same desert, same type of inspection. The two questions cover the biggest scoping and budget gaps without turning the reply into a form.
Success signal: He accepts one of the two slots or names the three sites and the people in the Q3 budget conversation.
Research used: [S1]

Subject: Re: Autonomous inspection for our Atacama lithium sites

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Dear Mr. Castillo,

Thank you for your note and the Anglo American referral. You need drone-based inspection for
three large 24/7 lithium extraction sites in the Atacama, because contracted crews are
expensive and hazardous, ahead of a Q3 budget conversation.

The aim: fewer people on hazardous rounds, more frequent scheduled coverage, and a cost case
ready for Q3.

Your company already has a reference point: SQM's digital innovation team runs docked drones
with Adentu and FlytBase across a 678 km² operation in northern Chile, and the published case
study reports inspection time cut from days to hours with more than 95 percent mission
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reliability.

A pilot could start with one dock at one site.

Two questions to prepare:
1. Which three sites do you have in mind, and how often do crews inspect them today?
2. Who else will take part in the Q3 budget conversation?

Would a 30-minute call on Tuesday 10 November at 10:00 or Wednesday 11 November at 15:00
(Santiago time) suit you? You are welcome to bring a safety or IT colleague.

Con gusto podemos continuar en español.

Kind regards,
Samruddhi Sontakke
Business Development, FlytBase
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Email 2 - +2 business days, Tuesday 10 November 2026 around 12:00 Santiago time (after the first proposed slot passes), same thread

Goal: Add the IT and connectivity precedent and restate the call with a new time, framed around his success criteria
Gaps targeted: Decision Criteria
Why this email now: Large mining buyers usually stall on IT and security questions. Giving the integration precedent early removes one likely objection and adds something new he would miss without this email. It keeps the same call ask with a fresh time.
Success signal: He replies with criteria (heat, dust, connectivity, integration) or accepts the call.
Research used: [S1]

Subject: Re: Autonomous inspection for our Atacama lithium sites

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Dear Mr. Castillo,

One detail that may help your IT colleagues: in SQM's existing deployment, the docked drones
send RGB and thermal imagery to SQM's Azure environment, with connectivity over Starlink. Data
handling at a remote desert site already has a working precedent inside SQM.

If useful, a 20-minute call on Thursday 12 November at 11:00 Santiago time could list what a
pilot would need to prove at your sites, such as dust and heat tolerance, remote operation and
integration with your systems. Would that time work?

Kind regards,
Samruddhi Sontakke
Business Development, FlytBase
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Email 3 - About +7 business days, Wednesday 18 November 2026, 10:00-12:00 Santiago time, same thread

Goal: Give peer proof from the referrer and a summary he can paste internally, then ask a smaller yes/no
Gaps targeted: Champion, Decision Process
Why this email now: After two touches without a reply, the likely blocker is that he needs to bring colleagues in. A peer deployment from the company that referred him, plus a five-line summary, gives him something to forward and coaches him as a champion. The ask shrinks to a yes/no.
Success signal: He forwards the summary, copies a colleague, or says yes to a call.
Research used: [S32, S2, S1]

Subject: Re: Autonomous inspection for our Atacama lithium sites

```
Dear Mr. Castillo,

Since Anglo American referred you, their case may help: at Quellaveco in Peru they run a
FlytBase drone-in-a-box with regional partner UAV Latam, flying scheduled inspections without
on-site pilots.

A summary you can forward internally:
- Problem: costly, hazardous contracted inspection at three 24/7 sites
- Approach: docked drones on scheduled, remotely run missions
- Safety: fewer people on hazardous rounds
- IT: imagery already reaches SQM's Azure environment
- Next step: a one-site pilot scoped before the Q3 budget conversation

Is a short call next week still useful, with your safety or IT colleagues if you wish?

Kind regards,
Samruddhi Sontakke
Business Development, FlytBase
```

Email 4 - About +14 business days, Wednesday 25 November 2026, 10:00-12:00 Santiago time, same thread

Goal: Close the loop without pressure, offer to hold until his stated timeline and learn the paper process
Gaps targeted: Paper Process
Why this email now: Three touches without a reply means it is time to stop. A respectful close tied to his own Q3 timeline keeps the relationship warm and avoids guilt. The question targets the last open gap, the paper process, and uses the supply chain function that research shows in the lithium

operations' leadership team (S15).
Success signal: He names a date to reconnect or refers us to a procurement or supply chain contact.
Research used: [S15]

Subject: Re: Autonomous inspection for our Atacama lithium sites

```
Dear Mr. Castillo,

I will close the loop here so this does not crowd your inbox. I am glad to hold this until your
Q3 budget conversation and come back with a one-site pilot scope and cost case for it.

Should I check back ahead of that date, or is a colleague in supply chain better placed to
explain how a new vendor is onboarded?

Kind regards,
Samruddhi Sontakke
Business Development, FlytBase
```

Branches (adapt to his reply)

- **If he replies:** Positive: he accepts a slot or proposes a time
  Then: Answer within the business hour, send the invitation, invite the AE and, after checking with the SQM account owner, Adentu. Pause the sequence.

```text Dear Mr. Castillo,

Thank you. I will send the invitation for the time you chose, together with our Account Executive. If you agree, we can also invite Adentu, the Chilean integrator behind SQM's current FlytBase deployment.

To make the call useful, it would help to know the three sites beforehand. We will bring a one-site pilot outline you can take into the Q3 budget conversation.

Kind regards, Samruddhi Sontakke Business Development, FlytBase ``` - **If he replies:** Not until Q3 / budget not approved yet
**Then:** Thank him, offer one small step (a pilot scope or business-case brief for finance), log the date as a CRM task and stop the sequence until then.

```text Dear Mr. Castillo,

Thank you, that timing makes sense. So you are ready for the Q3 conversation, we can prepare a short brief with a one-site pilot scope and the cost and payback figures SQM's existing deployment reported, at no commitment.

Would it help if I sent that brief two weeks before the budget meeting? If you share the date, I will diarise it.

Kind regards, Samruddhi Sontakke Business Development, FlytBase ``` - **If he replies:** Referral to a colleague (for example the maintenance and automation, IT or supply chain team)
**Then:** Thank him, write to the named person citing his referral, copy him only if appropriate, and log both contacts.

```text Dear Mr. Castillo,

Thank you for pointing me to your colleague. I will write to them today, mention that you suggested it, and share the same context on the three sites and the Q3 budget conversation. I will keep you copied unless you prefer otherwise.

Kind regards, Samruddhi Sontakke Business Development, FlytBase ``` - **If he replies:** Objection: IT/security review, permits for remote flights, or 'we already have a drone vendor'
**Then:** Acknowledge why it matters, give the approach and one proof point, and ask one follow-up question. Bring in the AE for the technical detail.

```text Dear Mr. Castillo,

That is a fair concern, and the right moment to raise it. In SQM's existing deployment, imagery from the docked drones goes to SQM's own Azure environment, so data stays inside your systems, and the work is delivered locally with Adentu in Chile. Permits and security review would be part of the pilot scope from the start.

Which review would come first on your side, so we can prepare the right documents?

Kind regards, Samruddhi Sontakke Business Development, FlytBase ``` - **If he replies:** Out of office auto-reply
**Then:** Pause the sequence until the day after his return date, note any stand-in named in the auto-reply, and resend the most recent email then. Do not contact the stand-in unless the auto-reply invites it.

```text Dear Mr. Castillo,

Welcome back. Picking up your request about drone inspection for the three Atacama lithium sites: would a 30-minute call on one of the next two Tuesdays or Wednesdays, at 10:00 or 15:00 Santiago time, suit you?

Kind regards, Samruddhi Sontakke Business Development, FlytBase ``` - **If he replies:** No reply after Email 4
```

Then: Mark the lead as a ghost, not dead. Move to value nurture every 4-6 weeks, and set a CRM task for one refreshed touch about a month before his Q3 budget conversation.

```text Dear Mr. Castillo,

With your Q3 budget conversation approaching, here is the one-site pilot outline mentioned earlier, based on how SQM's existing docked-drone deployment started: one dock, one zone, one use case. If a 20-minute call to adapt it to your three sites would help, I can suggest two times in Santiago time.

Kind regards, Samruddhi Sontakke Business Development, FlytBase ``` - **If he replies:** Polite non-commitment (for example 'lo vamos a ver')
**Then:** Log it as not yet, not as interest. Confirm in writing what happens next and who owns it.

```text Dear Mr. Castillo,

Thank you. To confirm next steps: I will hold until you have reviewed it internally and check back on a date that suits you. If a colleague should receive the summary in the meantime, I am happy to send it.

Kind regards, Samruddhi Sontakke Business Development, FlytBase ``` - **If he replies:** No / unsubscribe / hostile
**Then:** Stop on every channel immediately, do not argue, and record the opt-out in the CRM.

```text Dear Mr. Castillo,

Understood, thank you for letting me know. I will not contact you further about this.

Kind regards, Samruddhi Sontakke Business Development, FlytBase ```

## Stage 4 - Case Study Match

*Scanned 24 case studies on flytbase.com.*

**Best match:** How SQM Turned a 678 $km^2$ Mine into an Autonomous Inspection Zone

This is FlytBase's own case study about SQM, the lead's company. It covers an autonomous inspection deployment in the Atacama Desert in northern Chile, so the industry, country, terrain and climate all match. It shows dock-based drones replacing manual field inspections across a 678 $km^2$ operation, which is close to Rodrigo Castillo's goal of replacing expensive, hazardous contracted crews at 3 large 24/7 sites. Because the work was done with Chile-based integrator Adentu and connected to SQM's Azure environment, the integration and local-delivery questions already have
```

answers inside SQM. One caveat: the case study describes iodine/nitrate irrigation inspection under SQM's innovation team, not the lithium brine sites. The pitch is therefore an internal expansion from a proven SQM pilot to the Northern Operations lithium sites, not a cold reference.

- SQM "cut inspection time from days to hours" (S1)
- "achieved more than 95 percent mission reliability" (S1)
- "doubled inspection frequency" (S1)
- "improved iodine extraction yield by two percent" (S1). The page headline instead says "4× iodine yield improvement", so check which figure FlytBase uses before quoting either one.
- Deployment covers SQM's "678 km^2 mining operation in northern Chile" in the Atacama Desert, started as "one DJI Dock, one zone, one use case" (S1)
- "The FlytBase platform let us automate daily missions, health checks, and data transfers, building a truly hands-free workflow" - José Pablo Mujica, Adentu (S1)

How to use it: Open with it. Something like: 'SQM's digital innovation team already runs FlytBase autonomous docks with Adentu across your 678 km^2 Atacama operation.' Then frame the Northern Operations lithium sites as the next step and offer to bring the Adentu/FlytBase team that ran the pilot. Before outreach, the AE should check with the FlytBase account owner whether SQM is an active customer, and should ask Rodrigo whether he already knows Rodrigo Toler (Deputy Manager of Digital Innovation), because an internal champion shortens the Q3 budget conversation. Lead with the 'days to hours' inspection time and the >95% reliability figures, since they answer the crew cost and hazard pains directly. Avoid quoting the yield figure until it is reconciled.

Runner-up: How Anglo American Uses Autonomous Drones to Transform Mining Safety in Peru - This is the referrer's own deployment. Anglo American runs FlytBase drone-in-a-box at the Quellaveco copper mine in Peru with LATAM implementation partner UAV LATAM. The case study says it replaced manual flights and truck travel and improved personnel safety in hazardous mountainous terrain. Use it to acknowledge the referral and to show a LATAM peer-miner deployment at scale. UAV LATAM is also a possible regional partner for Stage 5, alongside Adentu.

Referral connection (Anglo American): FlytBase's site has a case study on Anglo American, the referrer named in the email. Anglo American deployed FlytBase-powered drone-in-a-box at its Quellaveco copper mine in Peru through implementation partner UAV LATAM, replacing manual drone flights and truck transport between survey points for its topography team. Docks are placed on elevated positions to keep communication across mountainous terrain. The referral most likely comes from this LATAM mining deployment. link

Existing relationship with SQM: Yes. FlytBase's case study shows SQM already partnered with Adentu (a Chile-based drone-autonomy integrator) and FlytBase. Together they took autonomous inspection from a pilot to a daily routine across SQM's 678 km^2 mining operation in the Atacama, northern Chile. The operation was irrigation leak, sprinkler and thermal inspection that affects iodine

extraction, using DJI Dock drones scheduled by FlytBase, with data relayed to SQM's Azure environment for ML analysis. Reported results: inspection time cut from days to hours, >95% mission reliability, doubled inspection frequency, and improved iodine yield (the body says two percent, the headline says 4x). The case study is driven by SQM's digital innovation team (Rodrigo Toler), while the inbound lead comes from the Northern Operations Division for lithium sites, so this enquiry is likely a new division or use case within an existing account. link

People named on FlytBase's site (warm contacts)

- **Rodrigo Toler**, Deputy Manager of Digital Innovation, SQM - An internal SQM stakeholder who has already seen FlytBase autonomy work. He is a potential internal champion or technical evaluator for expanding to the Northern Operations lithium sites, and a good person to mention or loop in. [S1]
- **José Pablo Mujica**, Commercial Manager, Adentu - Commercial lead at the Chile-based integrator that delivered SQM's FlytBase deployment. He is the natural partner contact for a partner-led expansion and for local deployment and support. [S1]
- **Kimberly Rojas Ruiz**, Not stated on page, UAV LATAM - Quoted in the referrer's (Anglo American's) case study as the implementation partner voice. She can help confirm the referral context and is an alternative LATAM partner contact. [S2]

Case study	Fit	Industry	Use case	Context
How SQM Turned a 678 km² Mine into an Autonomous Inspection Zone	95	Exact: mining, and it is the lead's own company (SQM)	Strong: autonomous DJI Dock inspection that replaced manual field-engineer walking/driving inspections (irrigation leaks, sprinklers, thermal)	Exact: Atacama Desert, northern Chile, 678 km² open-area operation, daily scheduled missions; same harsh desert environment and scale as the lead's 3 lithium sites
How Anglo American Uses Autonomous Drones to Transform Mining Safety in Peru	85	Exact: mining (copper), and it is the referrer named in the email	Good: drone-in-a-box replacing manual drone flights and truck travel for topographic surveys; personnel safety in hazardous areas	Good: large LATAM mine (Quellaveco, Peru), difficult mountainous terrain, docks placed on elevated positions for comms; regional LATAM partner UAV LATAM
MSS Security Transforms Airport Safety with BVLOS Drone Operations in Australia	30	Weak: security/airport	Partial: regular autonomous night perimeter inspections, BVLOS	Weak: shows regulatory BVLOS approval and multi-dock operation but not industrial/mining

Case study	Fit	Industry	Use case	Context
How CSX Enhances Rail Safety with Autonomous Drone Inspections	30	Weak: rail transportation	Partial: autonomous infrastructure inspection that removes personnel from dangerous situations	Partial: multi-site rollout (13 sites across 10 locations), similar to the lead's 3-site scale-out
EnBW Case Study: Autonomous Drones for Gigawatt Solar Portfolio	25	Weak: solar energy	Partial: autonomous docks replacing consultant-based inspections and long trips to remote sites	Weak: Germany, weather-constrained; cost argument (3-4x more inspections at same budget) is relevant to the expensive-crews pain
How TNB Reduced Warehouse Inventory Verification Time by 90x with Autonomous Drones In Malaysia	15	Weak: energy utility warehouse	Weak: inventory verification	Weak: 43-hectare single facility, Malaysia

Stage 5 - Partner & Go-to-Market Motion

Recommended motion: AE-led with partner (co-sell)

- **Region:** LATAM, Chile (Atacama Desert, northern Chile). Spanish-speaking, three remote 24/7 lithium sites that need in-country hardware installation, dock maintenance and field support FlytBase cannot provide remotely. FlytBase's partner page lists in-country and regional partners (S16).
- **Deal Complexity:** High. Enterprise mining account, 3 large-scale 24/7 sites, a buying committee that will include operations, digital innovation, IT/OT (Azure integration per S1), safety and procurement, budget only at the Q3 conversation stage. P1 lead (ICP fit 91). This needs a FlytBase AE owning the enterprise relationship, multi-site commercial structure and the expansion story, with a local integrator doing deployment.
- **Partner Availability:** Strong. Adentu is a Chile-based integrator that already delivered FlytBase at SQM (S1, S18). FlytBase's partner page lists Dronestore Chile (Gold System Integrator, Chile) and UAVLatam (Bronze System Integrator, Argentina), plus Drone Nerds LATAM (Gold Reseller, Colombia) (S16). UAVLatam also delivered the referrer's Anglo American Quellaveco deployment (S2).
- **Existing Account Relationship:** Yes. FlytBase case study S1: SQM 'partnered with Adentu and FlytBase' across its 678 km^2 operation in northern Chile, run by SQM's digital innovation team (Rodrigo Toler). The inbound is from a different division (Northern Operations, lithium), so this

is an expansion inside an existing account. The FlytBase account owner for SQM should be checked before outreach.

Partner	Type	Country	Evidence	Role in deal	Verified in sources
Adentu	System Integrator	Chile	S1: 'That need led them to Adentu, a Chile-based integrator specializing in drone autonomy, and FlytBase' and 'Adentu's engineers started small: one DJI Dock, one zone, one use case.' S18: Adentu 'provides drone services for inspections, thermal imaging... for sectors including electrical, mining...' and is 'based in Santiago, Chile.'	First choice. Already delivered FlytBase docks for SQM in the Atacama, knows SQM's sites, people (Rodrigo Toler), Azure data pipeline and vendor onboarding. Lead deployment, dock install, on-site support and local Spanish-language delivery for the 3 lithium sites; reuse existing SQM vendor status to shorten the paper process. Contact named in S1: José Pablo Mujica (Commercial Manager). Note: Adentu does not appear in the S16 partner list, so the AE should confirm its current FlytBase partner status.	yes
Dronestore Chile	System Integrator	Chile	S16 FlytBase partner network: 'Dronestore Chile Gold System Integrator Solution Provider Chile'	In-country backup. Gold-tier FlytBase System Integrator in Chile; can cover hardware supply, dock deployment and support if Adentu lacks capacity for three simultaneous 24/7 sites, or if SQM procurement requires a competitive or listed partner.	yes
UAVLatam	System Integrator	Argentina	S16: 'UAVLatam Bronze System Integrator Solution Provider Argentina'. S2: Anglo American deployed drone-in-a-box at Quellaveco 'through a strategic partnership with UAV LATAM' (quote from Kimberly Rojas Ruiz, UAV LATAM).	Regional mining reference and secondary option. Delivered the referrer's (Anglo American) FlytBase mining deployment in Peru; useful to validate the referral, share mining dock lessons (elevated dock placement, comms in difficult terrain) and act as a reference call.	yes

Partner profile needed: A Chile-based, Spanish-speaking System Integrator with mining experience and DJI Dock / FlytBase deployment track record, able to install and maintain docks at remote Atacama sites 24/7 (heat, dust, wind), handle connectivity and integrate with SQM's IT (Azure), and preferably already an approved SQM vendor.

- **flytbase_ae:** Owns the SQM relationship and deal: aligns with the existing SQM account owner, runs discovery with Rodrigo Castillo (Economic Buyer, decision criteria, paper process), builds the multi-site business case for the Q3 budget conversation, structures commercials and licensing, and brings in the SQM digital innovation team as an internal reference.
- **partner:** Adentu (or Dronestore Chile as backup): site surveys at the 3 lithium sites, solution design, dock hardware supply and installation, pilot execution, on-site maintenance and local support, Spanish-language training for field teams.
- **bdr:** Sends the first response the same day (P1), books discovery with the AE, confirms Adentu's current partner status and the SQM account owner internally, and arranges the intro to Adentu and optionally a UAVLatam/Anglo American reference.

Stage 6 - AE Handoff Summary

Buyer: Rodrigo Castillo (r.castillo@sqm.cl), Head of Operations, Northern Operations Division, SQM, Chile. He came in through flytbase.com/contact, referred by Anglo American. He is a senior operations owner, but his budget authority is not confirmed. Research found no public record of him or of a 'Northern Operations Division'. Since 27 Dec 2025 the Atacama lithium operations sit inside Nova Andino Litio (Novandino), the Codelco-SQM joint venture [S7][S33], so he may sit in SQM or in Novandino.

What he cares about: - Cutting the cost of contracted inspection crews across 3 large sites that run 24/7 (his own word: 'expensive') - Getting people off hazardous outdoor rounds. The labour authority describes the SQM Salar site at about 2,300 m with outdoor workers exposed to large thermal swings, and partially suspended work there in Feb 2026 [S30][S31] - Having a fundable case ready for the internal budget conversation he mentioned for Q3 - Reliability at operations running at full capacity [S19], in harsh desert conditions (heat, dust, wind, connectivity) [S30]

Others likely involved: - Rodrigo Toler, Deputy Manager of Digital Innovation, SQM - Named in FlytBase's SQM case study as the internal voice of the existing FlytBase/Adentu dock program [S1]. Potential internal champion and reference for the lithium expansion. Ask Rodrigo Castillo whether they know each other. - José Pablo Mujica, Commercial Manager, Adentu - Commercial contact at the Chilean integrator that delivered SQM's FlytBase deployment [S1]. Likely co-sell and delivery partner, once Adentu's current partner status is confirmed. - Gerson Salas, maintenance and automation manager (Novandino; previously SQM automation and energy manager) - Natural

technical evaluator for docked drones [S15][S21]; has spoken publicly about electrification, efficiency and start-up investment [S21]. - Andrés Pinto, digitalization and IT manager - Likely reviewer for data integration, Azure/cloud and cybersecurity [S15]. - Germán Pérez, supply chain manager - Likely owns vendor onboarding and procurement (Paper Process) [S15]. Email 4 asks whether a supply chain colleague should explain onboarding. - Eduardo Foix, finance manager, Nova Andino Litio (Codelco-designated) - Likely in the budget approval path for the Q3 conversation [S17]. - Carlos Díaz, general manager, Nova Andino Litio - Top executive over the Atacama lithium operations; likely final operational sponsor for a multi-site program [S15][S17]. - FlytBase account owner for SQM (internal role) - SQM is an existing account per the case study [S1]. Align before the call to avoid duplicate contact or channel conflict.

Qualification: MEDDPICC - ICP 91/100, completeness 44%, priority 77/100, P1 - Hot: respond same business day, involve AE early
Knowns: Identify Pain (known): contracted inspection crews are expensive and hazardous; Scope: 3 large-scale lithium extraction sites in the Atacama Desert, running 24/7; Champion (partial): Rodrigo Castillo reached out directly; senior operations leader; Economic Buyer / Decision Process (partial): an internal budget conversation is scheduled for Q3; budget owner not named; Competition (partial): status quo is contracted crews; the referrer runs FlytBase drone-in-a-box at Quellaveco with UAV Latam [S32][S2]; Existing relationship: SQM runs FlytBase docks with Adentu across a 678 km² operation in northern Chile, reporting >95% mission reliability, a USD 70-80k investment and ROI in under a year [S1]
Unknowns: Economic Buyer: who owns and signs the budget (Rodrigo, Novandino leadership or SQM corporate); Metrics: current crew spend, inspection frequency, safety incidents, target coverage; Decision Criteria: dust/heat tolerance, BVLOS/remote ops, integration, data security, pricing model; Decision Process: steps after the Q3 conversation; whether a single-site pilot comes first; Paper Process: contracting entity (SQM vs Novandino), procurement, tender or security review path; Champion strength: will Rodrigo sell this internally and does he influence the budget owner; Competition: other drone vendors or in-house options under evaluation; Which 3 sites he means; public sources describe 2 main lithium sites (Salar de Atacama and the Carmen plant) [S8]; Which Q3 he means: it is November 2026, so calendar Q3 2026 has passed; likely fiscal or 2027

Top 3 research highlights 1. Per FlytBase's case study, SQM already runs DJI Dock drones on FlytBase with Chilean integrator Adentu across a 678 km² operation in northern Chile, sending RGB and thermal data to SQM's Azure environment over Starlink. It reports >95% mission reliability, a total investment of USD 70-80k with ROI in under a year, and extra docks ordered for 24/7 security surveillance. [S1, S10] - *This is an expansion of an existing account, not a cold start. Desert reliability, Azure integration, local delivery and payback are already proven inside SQM and give Rodrigo numbers for his budget case. Caveat: the existing program is iodine/nitrate under the digital innovation team, not lithium.* 1. Since 27 Dec 2025 the Atacama lithium operations are run by Nova Andino Litio (Novandino), the Codelco-SQM joint venture holding them until 2060, with a joint

Codelco/SQM board and a Codelco-designated finance manager (Eduardo Foix). SQM consolidates Novandino until 2030; Codelco holds 50% plus one share afterwards. [S7, S33, S17] - *The contracting entity and approvers are probably Novandino, not SQM S.A. Expect extra approval layers and possibly state-company procurement rules, so confirm entity and Paper Process early and keep the first ask below board level (opex or low-capex pilot).* 1. SQM's August 2026 guidance puts capex at about US$3B for 2026-2028, roughly 60% for Novandino, including about US$300M per year of sustaining capex across divisions; 1H2026 net income was US$1,024.7M on US$4,228.5M revenue. In Nov 2025 SQM had cut its capex estimate and postponed some investments. [S11, S9] - *Money exists and sustaining capex is a natural home for inspection technology, but management is capital-disciplined. Pitch a phased, fast-payback one-site pilot sized like SQM's existing USD 70-80k deployment, not a large infrastructure ask.*

Case study: How SQM Turned a 678 km² Mine into an Autonomous Inspection Zone - FlytBase's own case study about the lead's company, in the same Atacama desert conditions [S1]. Dock-based drones replaced manual field inspections at scale: inspection time cut from days to hours, >95% mission reliability, inspection frequency doubled, delivered with Chilean integrator Adentu. It is the single proof point used in Email 1. Use the Anglo American Quellaveco case study (https://flytbase.com/case-studies/anglo-american-autonomous-mining-drones-peru-case-study) [S2] as the secondary piece to acknowledge the referral (Email 3). Don't quote the iodine yield figure: the body says 2%, the headline says 4x.

GTM motion: AE-led with partner (co-sell). The FlytBase AE owns the enterprise relationship, multi-site business case and commercials. Adentu, the Chile-based integrator that delivered SQM's FlytBase docks [S1], leads site surveys, dock install, the pilot and 24/7 local support. Dronestore Chile, a Gold System Integrator on FlytBase's partner page, is the in-country backup [S16]. UAVLatam is the referral and mining reference via Anglo American Quellaveco [S2].

Next step: BDR sends Email 1 today (reply on his thread, SQM case study as proof, two questions on sites/inspection frequency and who joins the Q3 budget conversation, Spanish offered). In parallel, check with the FlytBase SQM account owner and confirm Adentu's current partner status before Adentu is named in any call invite. AE joins the 30-minute discovery call on one of the proposed slots, Tue 10 Nov 10:00 or Wed 11 Nov 15:00 Santiago time. On the call: confirm his role and entity (SQM vs Novandino), which 3 sites, which Q3 and who owns the budget, what a solution must prove in Atacama conditions, and the vendor onboarding path. Close by proposing a one-site docked pilot with Adentu, scoped for his budget conversation. (owner: FlytBase AE (BDR sends Email 1 and books the call; AE runs discovery and the internal account-owner alignment), by: Email 1 today, 5 Nov 2026 (P1, same business day). Account-owner and Adentu check before the call. Discovery call Tue 10 or Wed 11 Nov 2026; if no reply, follow-ups go 10, 18 and 25 Nov per the sequence.)
Why: Hot P1 (ICP 91, warm referral, clear cost and safety pain) inside an account that already uses FlytBase [S1]. The biggest gaps (Economic Buyer, Decision Criteria, Paper Process) only close in a live

conversation. Aligning internally first avoids duplicate outreach and channel conflict with Adentu. A single-site pilot through the existing integrator fits SQM's capital discipline [S9] and reuses a proven delivery path [S1].

Watch-outs: No public record of Rodrigo Castillo or a 'Northern Operations Division'. Verify his role and entity before scoping.; Public sources describe 2 main lithium sites (Salar de Atacama and the Carmen plant) [S8], not 3. The third may sit in another division.; It is November 2026, so 'Q3' may already have passed or may mean fiscal/2027. Ask; don't assume.; Adentu is not on FlytBase's public partner page [S16]. Confirm status and capacity for 3 more 24/7 sites; bringing in another integrator without aligning risks channel conflict.; The existing FlytBase deployment belongs to SQM's digital innovation team (iodine/nitrate). The lithium enquiry may have a separate budget and internal politics.; Novandino is a new JV with a Codelco-designated finance manager and joint board, which may add approval layers and state procurement rules [S7][S17].; BVLOS operations over large salar areas may need Chilean regulatory approval; docks must handle heat, dust and wind and need connectivity (the existing deployment uses Starlink [S1]).; The Feb 2026 labour-authority suspension [S30][S31] is AE context only; it was kept out of the emails on purpose. Don't raise it as a compliance failure.; Don't quote the case study's iodine yield figure until reconciled (2% in the body vs 4x in the headline).

Sources

- **S1** How SQM Turned a 678 km² Mine into an Autonomous Inspection Zone | FlytBase | FlytBase *(case_study)*
- **S2** How Anglo American Uses Autonomous Drones to Transform Mining Safety in Peru | FlytBase Case Study | FlytBase *(case_study)*
- **S3** MSS Security Transforms Airport Safety with BVLOS Drone Operations in Australia | FlytBase *(case_study)*
- **S4** How CSX Enhances Rail Safety with Autonomous Drone Inspections | FlytBase *(case_study)*
- **S5** EnBW Case Study: Autonomous Drones for Gigawatt Solar Portfolio | FlytBase *(case_study)*
- **S6** How TNB Reduced Warehouse Inventory Verification Time by 90x with Autonomous Drones In Malaysia | FlytBase *(case_study)*
- **S7** Codelco and SQM form NovaAndino Litio, the joint venture for the development of lithium in the Salar de Atacama | CODELCO - Corporación Nacional del Cobre, Chile *(recent_news)*
- **S8** SQM concreta reestructuración interna | Diario Financiero *(org_structure)*
- **S9** Lithium price rebound lifts SQM profits and demand outlook - Miningreporters.com *(budget_signals)*
- **S10** How SQM Achieved 4x Iodine Yield Improvement and Cut Inspection Time by 99% | FlytBase *(technology_adoption)*

- **S11** 2Q2026%20Earnings%20release_eng_VF.pdf *(budget_signals)*
- **S12** Novandino Litio ingresa plan de US$3.000 millones para proyectar operación en el Salar de Atacama hasta 2060 - Reporte Minero | El portal de minería en Chile *(recent_news)*
- **S13** Codelco detalla avances de NovaAndino y anticipa US$2.100 millones para el Estado en 2026 *(org_structure)*
- **S14** Nova Andino Litio y su proyecto de grandes desafíos en el Salar de Atacama - Reporte Minero | El portal de minería en Chile *(operations_context)*
- **S15** Expertos en litio, un hidrogeólogo italiano y hasta con 30 años en SQM: los 14 ejecutivos clave de NovaAndino | Diario Financiero *(org_structure)*
- **S16** Partner network | FlytBase *(partner_directory)*
- **S17** Nova Andino parte con 3.533 trabajadores y el Estado se hace de los más preciados activos de SQM en Chile y China | Diario Financiero *(operations_context)*
- **S18** Adentu - Products, Competitors, Financials, Employees, Headquarters Locations *(web)*
- **S19** Document *(budget_signals)*
- **S20** aa-sqm-success-story-data.pdf *(technology_adoption)*
- **S21** How SQM is driving forward with green innovations to prepare for its lithium partnership with Codelco - BNamericas *(investor_priorities)*
- **S22** Reddit r/mining: Chile's Lithium Nationalization Explained: Codelco, SQM, and Profit Splits *(reddit)*
- **S23** Reddit r/mining: Mechanical joining pipeline *(reddit)*
- **S24** Reddit r/mining: Codelco-SQM Joint Venture for Lithium Receives Key Regulatory Approval from Chile’s FNE *(reddit)*
- **S25** Reddit r/mining: 70% of the global supply is controlled by 3 companies! *(reddit)*
- **S26** Reddit r/mining: Why SQM (NYSE:SQM) is Best Positioned to Take Advantage of the Lithium Industry Boom *(reddit)*
- **S27** Reddit r/mining: SQM Signs Long-Term Lithium Deal with LG Energy The world’s largest lithium producer, SQM, has signed an agreement to supply LG Energy Solutions with approximately 55,000 metric tons *(reddit)*
- **S28** Reddit r/mining: SQM, the world's second largest lithium supplier, notes that there is no sign for the price decline to end in the near future. Lithium price tumbled by 8% in the first quarter and is *(reddit)*
- **S29** Reddit r/mining: World’s No. 2 lithium miner SQM sees demand growing by 17% this year *(reddit)*
- **S30** Dirección del Trabajo suspende parcialmente faenas de SQM Salar por incumplimientos en higiene y seguridad - DT - Noticias *(operations_context)*
- **S31** Programa de fiscalización a empresas extractoras de litio: suspensión parcial de faenas por incumplimientos en higiene y seguridad - DT - Noticias *(operations_context)*
- **S32** FlytBase Powers First Autonomous Drone System in Peruvian Mining for Anglo American | FlytBase *(technology_adoption)*

- **S33** e9d555bf-91e8-4747-bff0-cd1f419dd6f0 *(investor_priorities)*